🚴 Cycling Laws in Ottawa – Quick Guide

⚖️ Jurisdictions (Who makes the rules?)

Cycling laws come from 3 levels:

- **Province (Ontario)** → Highway Traffic Act
- **City of Ottawa** → local by-laws
- **Federal (NCC)** → parkways & federal roads

👉 Most rules follow the **provincial law**, with some local differences.

🪖 Helmet Law

- Required if **under 18 years old**
- Must be properly fitted
- Parents responsible for riders under 16

💰 Fine: **$60**

🔔 Required Equipment

🌞 Daytime

- Bell or horn (must use when needed)

🌙 Night / Low Visibility

Must have:

- Front **white/amber light**
- Rear **red light or reflector**
- Reflective materials (front & back)

💰 Fine: **$85**

🚲 Bike Lanes

- ❌ **Not mandatory** to use bike lanes
- ✔ You can ride on regular roads

🚫 Sidewalk Riding

- ❌ Not allowed (bike = vehicle)
- ✔ Only allowed to **cross** sidewalks

🛑 Stop Signs

- Must **come to a full stop**
- Stop:
  - At stop line OR
  - Before crosswalk OR
  - At intersection edge

↩️ Turning Signals

- Required **only if it affects others**

Hand Signals:

- Left turn → left arm straight
- Right turn →
  - Right arm straight OR
  - Left arm bent upward

⚡ Speed Limits

- Provincial law: applies to motor vehicles only
- BUT in Ottawa:
  - ✔ Speed limits **also apply to cyclists**

👮 Police Stops

- Must provide:
  - Name
  - Address
- No ID required, but must identify yourself

💰 Fine for not identifying: **$110**

✅ Example

Scenario:
A 16-year-old biking at night

- Wearing helmet ✔
- Has front light + rear reflector ✔
- Uses bell when approaching pedestrians ✔

Result:
✔ Fully legal
✔ Avoids fines

🚐 Accessible Transportation (WOCRC)

👥 Who Can Use It?

- Seniors & adults with **physical disabilities**
- Must be able to **transfer into a vehicle independently**
- Wheelchair-accessible vehicles available (on request)

👉 Special case:

- If a medical procedure involves **sedation**, a **companion is required**

📞 Booking a Ride

- Call: **613-591-3686 (option 3)**
- Must **book in advance**

🚗 Service Features

- Rides for:
  - Medical appointments
  - Grocery shopping
  - Community visits
- Drivers can:
  - Help with stairs or elevators
- Focus: **independence + mobility support**

💰 Pricing

🏘️ Suburban Areas

(Postal codes like K2B, K2J, K2L, etc.)

- 1–10 km → $12
- 11–30 km → $17
- 31–50 km → $22
- 51–70 km → $32
- 71–90 km → $42
- 91+ km → $0.50/km

🌾 Rural Areas

(Postal codes like K0A, K2W, etc.)

- 0–30 km → $11 (return trip)
- 31+ km → $19.50 (return trip)
- Grocery trips → $10 (return trip)

⚠️ Important Rules

- Parking fees = **paid by client**
- Cancel at least **24 hours in advance** (or may be charged)

🚌 Connection to Public Transit

- Works with OC Transpo
- Provides **rural partner routes**
- Helps connect users to broader transit network

✅ Example

Scenario:
A senior in a suburban area travels 15 km to a medical appointment

- Falls in **11–30 km range**

Result:
✔ Cost = **$17**
✔ Ride includes assistance if needed
✔ Safe, pre-booked transportation

💡 Key Idea

This service is designed to:

- Support **independence**
- Provide **accessible, reliable transportation**
- Help people stay **connected to their community**

Links:
https://bikeottawa.ca/bike-ottawas-guide-to-cycling-laws-in-ottawa/
https://wocrc.ca/program/transportation/